

Fourth Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Quarta Post Pentecosten

TLM propers: Christ's word orders a groaning world and a rebellious will

Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Connection
Introit	<i>Dominus illuminatio mea</i> (Ps. 26:1–3)	Light, salvation, courage	God's light does not deny conflict; it gives the endangered worshipper courage to enter it faithfully.
Collect	<i>Da nobis, quaesumus, Domine</i>	Providence, peace, devotion	The Church asks that the world's course be peacefully ordered and her own devotion made tranquil.
Epistle	Rom. 8:18–23	Creation's groaning and bodily glory	Present suffering belongs to a creation awaiting incorruption and the redemption of the body.
Gradual	<i>Propitius esto, Domine, peccatis nostris</i> (Ps. 78:9–10)	Forgiveness and deliverance	Before apostolic fruit, the Church confesses need and refuses to make results her own vindication.
Alleluia	<i>Deus, qui sedes super thronum</i> (Ps. 9:5, 10)	Judgment and refuge	The Judge enthroned above the sea interprets depth and failure under divine justice and refuge.
Gospel	Luke 5:1–11	Christ's word, the catch, vocation	Teaching precedes mission; abundance follows Christ's command and brings Peter to confession and vocation.
Offertory	<i>Illumina oculos meos</i> (Ps. 12:4–5)	Illumination against death	The offering asks for eyes kept awake when exhaustion and apparent futility invite surrender.
Communion	<i>Dominus firmamentum meum</i> (Ps. 17:3)	Refuge and deliverance	The one sent into the deep receives God himself as strength, refuge, and deliverer.
Postcommunion	<i>Mysteria nos, Domine, sumpta purificant</i>	Purification and protection	Mission ends neither in technique nor visible success: the mysteries purify and guard the laborer.

Four Senses of Scripture

Thread	Synthesis
Literal	Luke narrates Jesus teaching from Simon's boat, commanding a new cast after an empty night, granting a catch that strains nets and boats, and calling Peter to catch men; Romans describes creation and believers groaning for bodily redemption.
Allegorical	Augustine reads the first catch as the Church in her present, mixed condition. The boat bears Christ's teaching, and the net gathers people through the apostolic mission his word initiates.
Moral	The disciple submits discouragement and even a rebellious will to Christ's efficacious word, obeys after failure, confesses sin when grace bears fruit, and follows rather than claiming the catch.
Anagogical	Chrysostom reads creation's groaning as desire for incorruption and the body's perfect glory; Augustine contrasts the present mixed catch with the final shore and resurrection.

Core Scriptural Symbols

Thread	Synthesis
Boat	Augustine, <i>Tractate 122 on John 7</i> , treats Luke's first catch as a figure of the Church in this world. Editorially, Luke's order matters: Christ first teaches from Simon's boat, so mission remains under his doctrine rather than becoming private enterprise.
Net and Catch	Augustine reads the unsorted, straining catch as the Church's present mixed condition. Abundance is therefore not triumphal proof of purity; it demands shared labor, humility, discipline, and hope for the final shore.
Deep Water	Editorial synthesis: <i>duc in altum</i> names the place where mastery weakens and obedience becomes visible. The deep is not romantic ambition; it is the concrete situation into which Christ's command sends a tired disciple.
Groaning Creation	Chrysostom, <i>Homily 14 on Romans</i> , reads the personified creation as intensely awaiting freedom from corruption and sharing in humanity's promised incorruption. Its travail enlarges the fisherman's failed night into hope for bodily and cosmic renewal.

Patristic Exegesis of the Grouped Propers

Thread	Synthesis
1. Introit	Text/function: Psalm 26 names God as light, salvation, and defender before enemies. Editorial reading: mission begins in received illumination and courage, not confidence in technique.
2. Collect	Text/function: the Church asks that the world's course be peacefully directed by God's order and that she rejoice in tranquil devotion. Placement: before Paul names cosmic travail, the prayer places both world and Church under providence.
3. Epistle	Text/function: Romans 8 sets present suffering within creation's labor for glory and bodily redemption. Patristic control: Chrysostom insists that corruption is not final and that hope reaches both body and creation.

Thread	Synthesis
4. Gradual	Text/function: <i>Propitius esto, Domine, peccatis nostris</i> (Ps. 78:9–10) asks forgiveness and deliverance for the honor of God’s name. Placement: before apostolic fruit, the Church confesses need and refuses to make results her own vindication.
5. Alleluia	Text/function: <i>Deus, qui sedes super thronum</i> (Ps. 9:5, 10) acclaims the equitable Judge as refuge of the poor in tribulation. Editorial reading: the throne above the sea interprets depth and failure under divine justice and refuge.
6. Gospel	Text/function: Christ teaches, commands the cast, grants abundance, receives Peter’s confession, and transforms fear into vocation. Patristic control: Augustine sees this catch as the Church’s present gathering; obedience serves a Church still awaiting final purification.
7. Offertory	Text/function: <i>Illumina oculos meos</i> asks that the eyes not sleep in death or give the enemy occasion to boast. Placement: the tired worker offers his perception and discouragement before he offers achievement.
8. Secret	Text/function: <i>Oblationibus nostris, quaesumus Domine, placare susceptis</i> asks God mercifully to compel rebellious wills toward himself. Hinge: the deepest empty net is the resistant will; sacrifice places that will under the same efficacious word that filled Peter’s net.
9. Communion	Text/function: Psalm 17 gives the communicant God as strength, refuge, liberator, and helper. Placement: Christ does not merely issue a mission; he gives himself as the stability from which it continues.
10. Postcommunion	Text/function: the received mysteries are asked to purify and protect by their gift. Final effect: obedience becomes a sacramentally cleansed and guarded way of life rather than a single successful effort.

Grouped instruction (editorial synthesis). Divine light and providence frame a groaning creation; forgiveness and refuge prepare the hearing of Christ’s command; the Gospel exposes fruitless self-reliance; and the Secret identifies the will itself as the offering that must be drawn toward God. Communion then supplies the refuge and purification needed for continuing mission.

Exegetical Notes

- Luke places Christ’s teaching before the command to cast: apostolic action remains answer to a received word.
- Peter’s confession follows abundance. Fruitfulness reveals both Christ’s power and the apostle’s unworthiness without cancelling vocation.
- The Secret makes obedience explicitly graced: the Church asks God to draw resistant wills, not merely to reward strenuous effort.

Patristic and Sainly Witnesses

Witness	Text / source status	Homiletic use
St. John Chrysostom, <i>Homily 14 on Romans</i> 8:19–23	Direct quotation: “For this is full redemption, not a redemption only, but such, that we shall never again return to our former captivity.”	Keeps Romans’ promise bodily, final, and stronger than present corruption.

Witness	Text / source status	Homiletic use
St. Augustine, <i>Tractates on John</i> 122.7	Direct quotation: “The capture of fishes signified the good and bad presently existing in the Church.”	Checks triumphalism and gives the present catch an ecclesial and eschatological frame.
St. John Chrysostom, <i>Homily 14 on Romans</i> 8:19–23	Paraphrase: creation’s groaning expresses both the greatness of the promised good and desire for freedom from corruption.	Interprets travail as hope for incorruption rather than evidence of abandonment.

Homiletic Synthesis

Thread	Synthesis
Proposition	Christ’s efficacious word meets a groaning creation and a rebellious will, turning failed labor into humble, sacramentally sustained mission.
Movement I – gift	God gives light, providential order, a trustworthy word, an abundant catch, bodily hope, and himself as refuge.
Movement II – resistance	Discouragement treats empty nets as a final verdict; activism trusts technique; the resistant will hears Christ yet withholds itself from his command.
Movement III – sacramental conversion	The Offertory surrenders darkened sight, the Secret offers the rebellious will to God’s merciful action, and Communion strengthens and purifies the one sent again.
Final horizon	Obey one concrete command without demanding visible success first, labor within Christ’s Church, and await the resurrection in which body and creation share incorruption.

Preaching Applications

- Encourage those exhausted by faithful but apparently fruitless labor: failure is information, not a revelation that Christ has ceased to command.
- Ask where the real resistance lies; the Secret directs attention from adverse conditions to the will that still needs to be drawn toward God.
- Connect bodily and ecological anxiety to Romans’ promised incorruption without pretending that the text supplies a technical policy program.

Primary References

- *Missale Romanum* (1962), *Dominica Quarta post Pentecosten*; local OCR temporal corpus. Its Gospel heading reads *Luc. 6, 1–11*, an unresolved OCR error; the pericope itself is Luke 5:1–11.
- St. John Chrysostom, *Homilies on Romans*, Homily 14, comments on Rom. 8:18–23, [NPNF working English translation](#).
- St. Augustine, *Tractates on the Gospel of John*, Tractate 122.7, comparison of Luke 5 and John 21, [NPNF working English translation](#).

Full Patristic and Saintly Texts

- St. John Chrysostom, *Homily 14 on Romans*: “For this is full redemption, not a redemption only, but such, that we shall never again return to our former captivity.”
- St. Augustine, *Tractates on the Gospel of John* 122.7: “The capture of fishes signified the good and bad presently existing in the Church.”